EverFront pipeline report

William Zhu 2D track 1 November 2026

EverFront now has a coherent pixel science fiction presentation, modular character animation, authored enemies, industrial menus, native audio buses and three distinct Boss encounters. The production evidence supports using AI for constrained drafts and implementation assistance. It does not support treating a generated sprite sheet, measured volume or successful export as finished art direction or gameplay acceptance. This report is a retrospective review of surviving records; ratings below are current technical assessments, not fabricated diary entries.

Stage review

NR means not recorded, not zero. Actual and without AI times must be confirmed by the author. Optional skeletal rigging was not used in this frame by frame 2D track. The voice row uses the permitted no voice alternative.

Stage	Review rating out of5	Actual minutes	Without AI minutes
2D 0 Art direction	4	NR	NR
2D 1 Concept art	3	NR	NR
2D 2 Final art	3	NR	NR
2D 4 Animation	2	NR	NR
Shared E Environment	4	NR	NR
Shared UI UI art and text	4	NR	NR
Shared VFX Effects	3	NR	NR
Shared I Integration and review	4	NR	NR
SFX 1 Spotting	4	NR	NR
SFX 2 Sourcing	3	NR	NR
SFX 3 Editing and design	4	NR	NR
SFX 4 Implementation	4	NR	NR
SFX 5 Mixing	4	NR	NR
Music 1 Music direction	4	NR	NR
Music 2 Composition and production	3	NR	NR
Music 3 Mixing and mastering	3	NR	NR
Music 4 Implementation	4	NR	NR
Voice ALT No voice alternative	4	NR	NR

Where AI helped most

Implementation and integration. Event driven sound hooks, per frame atlas metadata and state cleanup turned selected assets into a playable system. The sword cue plays once on melee execution, and cannon audio excludes the second report in its source. The evidence is executable code and separate source manifests, rather than a prompt claiming success.

UI iteration. AI assistance made it practical to revise settings, progression and failure screens repeatedly. Human choices remained decisive: the developer rejected the stretched monitor stand and rolled back the revised build tree. Keeping labels in editable controls made those changes possible.

Repeatable audio preparation. Source duration analysis, leading silence removal, per file gain and native bus routing addressed concrete defects. The 60 second loop derivatives preserve full source songs. These operations are measurable, even though the final mix still needs listening approval.

Where AI helped least

Animation atlas precision. Multiple generated sheets placed blades, smoke or flashes across cells, changed scale, or ignored requested spacing. The new user mortar sheet needed a row split at y532 instead of the mathematical midpoint512. Fixed anchors and alpha inspection did more useful work than another generic assurance of consistency.

Final art consistency. Olive run art needed scale and palette correction; the cape needed layer and shoulder constraints; the mortar needed repeated mount and muzzle adjustment. A visually attractive image did not preserve the game specific attachment contract.

Rights and historical records. AI could organize filenames and locate two CC0 source pages, but it could not recover unrecorded account tiers, receipts or generation day terms. Missing provenance remains missing rather than becoming an ownership claim.

Time cost and production recommendation

The author reports "GPT Pro / 6.1 sol". Actual charges, task times and without AI estimates were not recorded, so a defensible total time saved cannot be calculated. The correct total is unknown, not zero or an invented percentage. Export duration and commit timestamps are not human labor measurements. A later author supplied time/cost sheet can fill this gap without rewriting production history.

If I ran a five person studio, I would assign AI assisted drafts to an art director, technical artist, gameplay programmer, audio designer and producer with explicit handoffs. I would use image generation for silhouette and effect candidates, Codex for constrained integration and documentation, and automated audio tools for repeatable edits. I would reserve final animation anchors, collision timing, readable UI hierarchy, source clearance and listening acceptance for named human owners. Each asset would have a source record before integration, a candidate cap, a play size review and a separate acceptance result. Current Windows/Web exports and a labeled historical/current gameplay video are supplied. Edge and Firefox checks use measured WebAudio signals; listening quality still requires human judgment. Remaining release gates are author time/cost confirmation, unresolved licenses and public deployment. No remote upload is claimed.